

033 Make a parachute

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MINS

Make this great parachute with a scrap of cloth, a cup, and thread. Launch it by throwing it straight up in the air. Add a small piece of clay to the cup as a weight and see if it affects how the parachute falls.

What you need

- Round piece of cloth 12 in (30 cm) in diameter
- Darning needle
- Paper cup • Thread



1 Make four holes in the edges of the cloth equal distances apart, like the four points of the compass.



2 Use the needle to push four 12 in (30 cm) threads through four equally spaced holes in the cup's rim, and tie to the cup.



3 Put the cup upside down in the center of the cloth. Use the needle to pull each thread through one of the cloth holes and secure with a knot.



Try it with and without a weight

034 Throw fall leaves in the air

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MINS

Throw fall leaves into the air. How many can you catch as they fall? Which shapes fall the slowest? Spray-paint a leaf, put it in the pile, then see who can find it fastest when you throw the leaves.

